Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings - a Wonder-placement mod for Civilization VII

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Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings

A Civilization VII mod. A city that filled its center in Antiquity has nowhere left to put a Wonder. This mod lets you build one over the buildings that age left behind: urban tiles whose buildings are all from an earlier age are offered on the Wonder placement screen, the old buildings are cleared, the walls stay, and the citizens they housed are yours to place through the game's own Grow City prompt.



Figure 1: Buseoksa, built over an Amphitheater and an Academy in Leeds

The game's own Wonder cinematic for a Wonder built this way. It is an ordinary Wonder: the tile is a real `DISTRICT_WONDER`*, and nothing about Wonders is redefined anywhere.*

There is no database change. Wonders keep their class, their one-in-the-world uniqueness, their cinematics, their terrain rules, the adjacency their neighbors read from a Wonder district, and whatever the AI does with them. The mod clears a tile and lets the game build on it, exactly as the game would build on any bare tile.

What the player does

Pick a Wonder in production. Urban tiles holding only antiquated buildings now show as valid sites alongside the usual ones.



Figure 2: The placement screen with an antiquated tile offered and its yield preview

The placement screen, with the mod's tile selected and the yield result the mod computes for it.

Choose one, exactly as you would choose an empty tile; the mod adds no prompt of its own. The buildings' demolition, the district's demolition and the Wonder's build order all go to the game in the same instant, so the tile goes straight from its old buildings to the Wonder's construction site and no empty ground is ever drawn. Walls come down with the district and are re-created on the Wonder's district a moment after it lands. Once the Wonder is standing, one citizen per building that housed one becomes pending population, and before the turn can end the game's own Grow City prompt asks where each settles: a rural tile or a specialist seat, wherever you like.



Figure 3: The game's Grow City screen holding the displaced citizens

The displaced citizens arrive as ordinary pending population, placed on the game's own screen. The city's head count is unchanged once they are placed.

Which tiles qualify

Tile holds	Offered
one antiquated building, free slot or not	yes
two or more antiquated buildings	yes
one antiquated beside one current-age	no
two current-age	no
anything Ageless (the Palace, the City Hall, a Harbor, unique-quarter buildings, Wonders)	no
walls, alongside any of the above	walls neither qualify a tile nor block it, and are kept

Antiquated means a previous age and not Ageless, or two ages back if you pick that in the options below. The engine enforces none of this on its own; left alone it offers any terrain-valid urban tile whatever stands on it. So this rule is the only thing that decides what is ever cleared. It lives in `lib/bwab-eligibility.js` with 36 tests.

Options

Options > Add-ons has a **Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings** header with two settings, in the main menu and in a game:

Setting	Choices	Default
Offer antiquated tiles for Wonders	on, off	on
Antiquated means	From any earlier age, From two ages back	From any earlier age

Turn the first off and a Wonder's placement screen shows only the game's own sites. A clear that's already under way still finishes. ”From two ages back” counts only buildings from two ages ago: in the Modern age a tile of Antiquity buildings is offered and a tile holding an Exploration building isn't, and in the Exploration age you'll see only the game's own sites. Ageless buildings and walls work the same under both choices, and the second setting is greyed out while the first is off.

The settings are yours rather than the save's. They're kept in the shared settings store that the bundled Tower Settings Keeper keeps readable, so they hold across a restart, and a save loads the same whatever they're set to. The mod reads them once and keeps them in memory, because the placement hook runs for every item in the production list. The design and the checks it still needs in a game are in docs/OPTIONS.md.

Which Wonders are offered a tile

The mod decides *where* a Wonder may go, not *whether* one may be built. A Wonder that is locked, not yet unlocked, or already standing somewhere in the world stays refused, exactly as the base game refuses it. Only a refusal that says there is nowhere to put it is this mod's business.

In one city, of 48 Wonders, 2 were buildable, 42 were refused for reasons that have nothing to do with any tile, and 4 were refused for want of a site. Only those last 4 are ones this mod can help with.

The Wonder's own placement rules are then checked before a tile is offered for it: terrain, biome, no-feature, river (required or forbidden), adjacent terrain, adjacent district, adjacent mountain, adjacent constructible, invalid adjacent biomes, homeland or distant lands, and a required constructible in the settlement. A rule the mod doesn't evaluate leaves that Wonder out rather than guessing. In the 1.5.0 data that's four Wonders on land: Ubudiah Mosque, which has to stand on a wet feature such as a marsh or an oasis; Shwedagon Zedi Daw and Muzibu Azaala Mpanga, which have to stand beside a lake; and Rila Monastery, which can't stand next to a district, when nearly every urban tile has one beside it. Battersea Power Station is left out too. Its data carries the next-to-land rule that the coast Wonders use, and the mod leaves out every Wonder with that rule. The appeal rule, the other feature tables (required, valid or invalid features) and the resource table would leave a Wonder out the same way, though no Wonder uses them in 1.5.0. So the mod sometimes offers less than the game would allow.

The Wonders that stand on Coast follow placement rules the game keeps to itself. Of the ones you can build once a tile is antiquated, Nan Madol is offered a coastal urban tile (a Lighthouse or Fishing Quay) only when the game already accepts it on a bare coast tile of the same city. Hale o Keawe and Havana Harbor carry the next-to-land rule and are left out, and so is the Statue of Liberty, which also has a river-placement rule the mod doesn't read.

If the game refuses the site after all

Civilization VII will not say whether a Wonder fits a tile until the tile is empty, and it enforces placement rules that are not in the data a mod can read. So a cleared tile can still be turned down.

The build order goes to the game together with the clear, so a refusal shows up as the tile failing to become a Wonder site. The mod watches the tile for about three seconds; if the Wonder has not appeared by then, it puts the tile back: the buildings it destroyed are re-created, then the walls, and it reads the tile afterward to confirm everything is standing. No citizens are displaced, because they are only added once the Wonder is on the tile. The hex is empty for those few seconds and then holds what it held before. On a coastal Wonder whose every readable rule passed and which the engine still refused, the tile came back holding its Lighthouse, with population, urban and rural counts unchanged and nothing left pending. A refusal costs a few seconds of empty hex and nothing else.

The yield preview

A tile the mod adds is not one the engine prepared placement data for, so the placement panel has nothing of its own to show for it. The mod answers with its own figure, built from the game's per-constructible numbers: the Wonder's base yields, minus the yields of the buildings that would go, plus the maintenance they would stop costing.

It is a first-order figure. Yields a Wonder grants conditionally, and adjacency the old buildings were receiving, are not modeled. No Wonder in the game has adjacency rows of its own, which is why the Wonder side of the subtraction is exact.

What it costs you

The tile. Those buildings' yields and maintenance are gone, the city has fewer building slots, and the tile holds the Wonder from then on. The citizens are not lost: the head count is unchanged once you have placed them.

Compatibility

- No database change, so a save loads with the mod on or off, and it can join a game already in progress. A Wonder built this way is ordinary constructible state.
- No base-game files are replaced, and mods that adjust Wonder data are unaffected, because this mod does not touch Wonder data.
- The clear and the build are the local player's own actions on the local player's own settlement. The AI builds Wonders exactly as it always has.
- Multiplayer works. In a LAN game the clear, the build and the displaced citizens all went through the network session, and a competing placement was refused by the game and rolled back intact.
- The text is in English, German, Spanish, French, Italian, Japanese, Korean, Polish, Portuguese (Brazil), Russian and Chinese (Simplified and Traditional), following the game's language setting.

Installation

1. Subscribe on the Steam Workshop, or download the zip from the latest release.
2. Unzip it so the `build-wonders-over-antiquated-buildings` folder sits in the Civilization VII Mods directory.
3. Enable **Build Wonders Over Antiquated Buildings** from Additional Content in-game.

Status

Works end to end on Civilization VII 1.5.0 as of 2026-09-24: a real mouse click on the hex, the one-building and two-building cases, walls kept on a hill tile, population conserved on both, the click going straight to the clear with no prompt of the mod's own, the yield preview on the hex and in the panel, a refusal rolling the tile back with nothing lost, a live LAN game, and the tile going from its buildings straight to the Wonder's construction site with no empty ground in between. Each step and the run behind it is in docs/RECIPE.md.

The two options, the translations and leaving out Rila Monastery are built and pass the offline tests, but they haven't been watched in a game yet. What a lab run has to show is listed at the end of docs/OPTIONS.md.

Layout

```
build-wonders-over-antiquated-buildings.modinfo   one game script and the Options rows, no data
ui/bwab-clear-and-build.js          the mod: placement hooks, the clear, walls, yield preview, rollback
ui/bwab-settings.js                 the two settings: defaults, read once and kept, the guarded write
ui/bwab-options.js                  the two rows in Options > Add-ons
ui/settings-keeper.js               Tower Settings Keeper BUILD 112, copied unchanged
lib/bwab-eligibility.js             the tile rule and the unread Wonder rules, 36 tests
text/en_us/ModText.xml              name, description and the Options text
text/<lang>/ModText.xml             the same text in each of 11 other languages
tests/eligibility.mjs               the rule's tests
tests/settings.mjs                  the settings' tests (11)
docs/RECIPE.md                      each engine step and the run behind it
docs/OPTIONS.md                     the two options, where they're kept, and the lab checks they need
docs/steam-workshop-description.md  the Workshop page text
docs/logo.svg, docs/logo.png        the Workshop preview image
gallery/                            the screenshots used above
devtools/README.md                  where the harness lives (mod_ideas_tested) and how to re-verify
eslint.config.js, tsconfig.json, types/, package.json, scripts/   dev tooling, not shipped
```

`install-dev.sh`	copies the mod into the game's Mods folder
`release.sh`	builds dist/: release zip, Workshop preview, steamcmd manifest
`CHANGELOG.steam.txt`	the Workshop change notes, built from CHANGELOG.md

`npm run verify` runs everything that can be checked without the game: `tsc --noEmit` over the JSDoc types, `eslint ui lib`, and the eligibility and settings tests. Zero errors and zero warnings is the bar. `npm run readme:pdf` builds `README.pdf` from this file.

In a running game, `globalThis.__bwab.enabled = false` makes every hook pass straight through, `globalThis.__bwab.uninstall()` restores the engine's own methods, and `globalThis.__bwab.settings()` shows the options as the script holds them; all three are for troubleshooting.

The routes that were tried and set aside, the probes, and the harness runs live in the author's working tree (`mod_ideas_tested/build_wonders_over_antiquated_buildings`), outside this repository; `devtools/README.md` lists the runs that verify this build.

Credits

Built by Tower. MIT licensed.